LESSON OVERVIEW

Introduction to football

Handling the ball under passive pressure, revisiting ball manipulation skills, and learning beat-the-player moves.

YEAR GROUP	CLASS	SPACE
Year 3	30 children	Outdoor

Before you start

Equipment: 45+ cones / 30 balls

Category: Invasion Games

Key learning objectives

- Shielding the ball
- Ball manipulation
- Beat the player moves

Whole child

- I can persevere
- I can follow the rules of the game
- I can take turns

Session at a glance

Warm-up	Escape the Castle	15 min
Challenge 1	Captain Hook	20 min
Challenge 2	Beat the player tunnel	10-15 min

Activity blocks total 45-50 minutes. Reflection and transitions have no specified duration in the source.

Teacher reminder

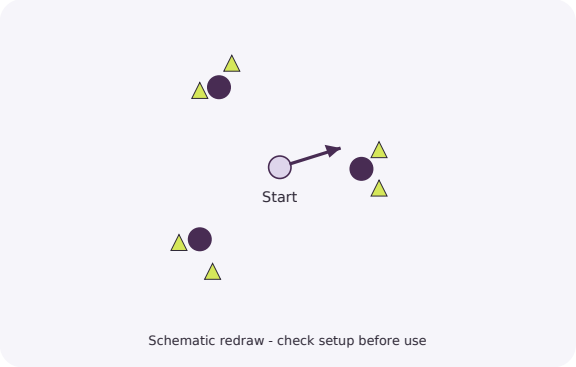
Remember to use the horseshoe technique.

Design example - content and diagrams require review. No new adaptation or safety guidance has been inferred.

WARM-UP / 15 min

Escape the Castle

30 x 30 area. Groups of four; 1 ball and 6 cones per group.



Schematic redraw - check setup before use

How to run it

• Use a 30 x 30 area. Children work in fours with 1 ball and 6 cones.

• Lay the cones in a circle to make 3 gates, each about 2 steps wide. Three players stand in the gates. One player starts in the middle, with no ball yet.

• The middle player counts 3, 2, 1, go, then tries to escape through a gate without being tagged. A tagged player goes back to the middle and starts again. If they escape, the player from that gate becomes the one in the castle.

• Gate players can only move side to side inside their gate.

Progression

• Add a ball. The escaping player dribbles out. Gate players still tag, and do not tackle.

• The ball must be dribbled under control. It is not kicked out of the castle.

• Make the gates bigger or smaller to change the challenge.

Teaching cues

• How many parts of the foot can you use to move the ball?

• Agility means changing direction at speed. Use it to trick the gate player.

• Stop turn: the sole stops the ball, then roll it back behind you as you turn. Keep the ball low as you dribble away.

• Drag back: the sole stays on the ball for longer as your body turns with the foot. The ball finishes in front of you.

• Move the ball with the outside, inside and sole of the foot.

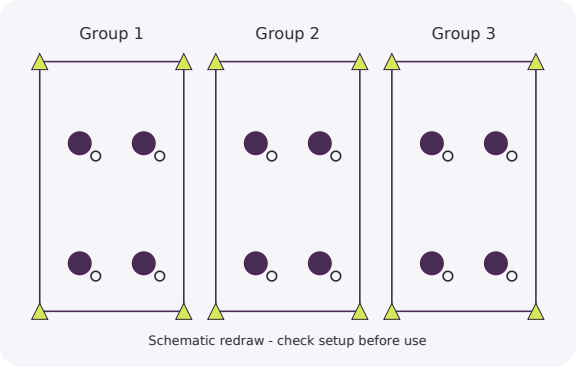
• The player inside the castle starts the game with a clear 3, 2, 1, go.

• Ask how the group managed taking turns.

CHALLENGE 1 / 20 min

Captain Hook

Three 20 x 10 tunnels. Split the class into three groups.



How to run it

• Cone out three tunnels, about 20 x 10. Split the class into three groups, one per tunnel. Each tunnel plays its own game.

• The tunnel is a pirate ship. Protect your own ball, and try to kick other players' balls off the ship. The ball can be called treasure.

• Start every tunnel together with a clear 3, 2, 1, go. The player still with their ball is the winner. If your ball is kicked out, collect it and carry on. You score a point when you kick someone else's ball off the ship.

• Play each game for about 2 minutes. Repeat 3 or 4 times, and move players between tunnels to balance the games.

Progression

• When a ball is kicked off, that player is out and practises toe taps at the edge of the tunnel until the game ends.

Teaching cues

• Each player keeps their own score: 1 point for every ball kicked off the ship.

• Use both feet to move the ball away from others.

• Dribble from slow to fast, with the ball under control.

• Shield the ball by putting your body between the ball and the other player. An arm can keep distance, with no pushing.

• Scan for a safe space to dribble into.

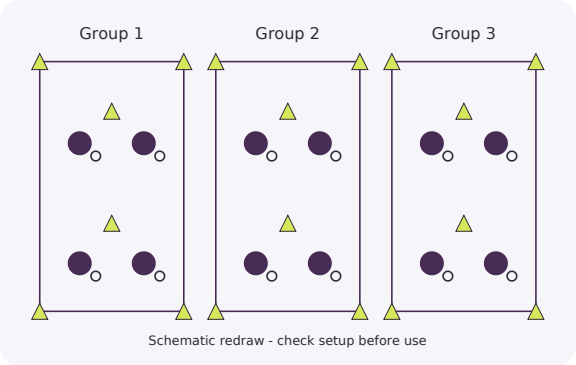
• When you make a mistake, how can you stay positive?

• Follow the rules so the game stays fair.

CHALLENGE 2 / 10-15 min

Beat the player tunnel

One ball per player. Cones inside each tunnel act as defenders.



How to run it

• Each player has a ball inside a tunnel. Cones in the tunnel act as defenders.

• On 3, 2, 1, practise a beat-the-player move at the cones. How close can you get to the cone?

• Spend about 2 minutes on a move, add the key points, then repeat. Do this for both moves.

Teaching cues

• Body swerve: lean one way as you approach the cone, then transfer your weight and explode away with the outside of the foot. That fake is called disguise.

• Feint shot or pass: shape as if you will shoot or pass, then use the inside of the foot to move the ball at an angle and drive past the cone.

• Ask children to demonstrate, then repeat the move and encourage perseverance.

• Keep the ball close. Change speed after the move to get away from the defender.

FINISH & REVIEW

Reflect on the learning

Use a bean bag when asking questions so everyone is ready to answer.

Ask the children

- Have the children understood the key learning objectives?
- Can they explain the coaching points?
- What is agility, and how did it help you escape the castle?
- How do you shield the ball, and when would you use it?
- What two beat-the-player moves did we learn? Ask for demonstrations.
- Why use speed after the move?
- What did you enjoy most, and what was most challenging? Did you persevere?

After you teach

- Did the children engage with the session?
- Did the children engage with the hook?
- Did you complete all the sections on the session plan?
- Did the reflection show that the children took on the key learning points?
- Did you enjoy this session? Note down why.

Your notes